Empowerment with English: Mid-semester Examination

Date: September 24, 2026 **Time:** 2 hours **Marks:** 40

Section A: Literature (29 marks)

Answer the following in about 150 words each.

1. Discuss the features of the dramatic monologue, and consider *either* Tennyson's "Ulysses" *or* Browning's "My Last Duchess" as a dramatic monologue. [10]

2. Write a dialogue of five exchanges on *one* of the following. [10]

   (a) Imagine the relieved Guru Nayak goes back to his village and narrates his meeting with the astrologer to his friend Sabapathy.

   (b) Imagine a conversation between Hardy and Littlewood in which Hardy shares the pleasures and challenges of working with an untrained genius.

3. Explain and comment on *any three* of the following quotations. [9]

   (i) *You have among you many a purchased slave*
   Which like your asses and dogs and mules,
   You use in abject and slavish parts...

   (ii) *But mercy is above the sceptred sway*
   It is enthroned in the hearts of kings

   (iii) *A Daniel still say I, a second Daniel!*
   I thank thee, Jew, for teaching me that word.

   (iv) *You may as well forbid the mountain pines*
   To wag their high tops and to make no noise...

Section B: Phonetics (11 marks)

4. Write your name in phonetic script. [1]

5. Answer *any two* of the following three questions. [10]

   I. Group the following words according to their vowel sounds in R.P. [5]

   wool, spice, flu, cool, chair, fear, high, chirp, bird, fight, wear, news

   II. Pick out the odd one in each of the following groups of words and say why you consider it odd. The first one is done for you. [5]

   1. good, should, food, wood, would
      Food is the odd one, as it has the long vowel /uː/ while the rest have the short vowel /ʊ/.
   2. gym, gum, jam, jest, geriatric
   3. cheer, chaste, charisma, change, chill

4. dare, share, beer, fair, bear
5. across, appoint, apple, awake, ago
6. switched, rubbed, lulled, prayed, gagged

III. Write the phonetic transcription of the following words. [5]

spoon *spun* *spine* *span* *spin*